CASE

2026. February 21., Saturday 16:38

WHEN, THEN, ELSE, END

CASE WHEN x = 1 THEN 'a'
WHEN x = 2 THEN 'b'
ELSE 'c' END AS new_column
ELSE returns a specified value if all WHEN statements are not true
Always include END and an alias in the end
This will evaluate to one column in the query
We can use AND inside the WHEN clause to test multiple statements
Usually we should filter the data so the query does the ELSE clause we want to for
If we remove ELSE clause, we get NULL values
We can filter for the CASE statement as well:

```
SELECT date, season,
  CASE WHEN hometeam_id = 8455 AND home_goal > away_goal
            THEN 'Chelsea home win!'
       WHEN awayteam_id = 8455 AND home_goal < away_goal
            THEN 'Chelsea away win!' END AS outcome
FROM match
WHERE CASE WHEN hometeam_id = 8455 AND home_goal > away_goal
                THEN 'Chelsea home win!'
           WHEN awayteam_id = 8455 AND home_goal < away_goal
                THEN 'Chelsea away win!' END IS NOT NULL;
```

CASE statements can categorize, filter and **aggregate** data

```
SELECT
    season,
    COUNT(CASE WHEN hometeam_id = 8650 AND home_goal > away_goal
          THEN 54321 END) AS home_wins,
    COUNT(CASE WHEN awayteam_id = 8650 AND away_goal > home_goal
          THEN 'Some random text' END) AS away_wins
FROM match
GROUP BY season;
```

season	home_wins	away_wins
2011/2012	6	8
2012/2013	9	7
2013/2014	16	10
2014/2015	10	8

It can return anything ('some random text' e.g.), the COUNT counts the number of rows

Percentages with CASE and AVG

```sql
SELECT
  season,
  AVG(CASE WHEN hometeam_id = 8455 AND home_goal > away_goal THEN 1
           WHEN hometeam_id = 8455 AND home_goal < away_goal THEN 0
           END) AS pct_homewins,
  AVG(CASE WHEN awayteam_id = 8455 AND away_goal > home_goal THEN 1
           WHEN awayteam_id = 8455 AND away_goal < home_goal THEN 0
           END) AS pct_awaywins
FROM match
GROUP BY season;
```